

Abiodun M. Musbaudeen

Department of Economics
Binghamton University (SUNY)

Phone: (607) 760-7889
E-mail: amusbau1@binghamton.edu
Website: abiodunmusbaudeen.com

Teaching Statement

Introduction

I enjoy teaching. I particularly enjoy helping students make sense of work they find difficult. I feel satisfaction when they make progress in this way. Typically, this progress grows out of one-on-one or small group coaching. I see time spent answering questions and revisiting explanations as an essential part of teaching. Across introductory courses and advanced topics, I encourage students to question assumptions, explain their reasoning, and apply economics to real-life situations.

At Binghamton University, I taught Statistical Methods in Summer 2025. I designed the syllabus, lectures, problem sets, data exercises, and assessments around the course's learning objectives, emphasizing statistical reasoning and the interpretation of results. My teaching assistantships span introductory and intermediate microeconomics, Principles of Macroeconomics, econometrics, and data analytics. I served as a teaching assistant for Principles of Macroeconomics in Spring 2023 and Spring 2025. In Introduction to Econometrics, I also lead R instruction.

Teaching Philosophy

I connect intuitive explanations with formal methods and practical applications. My standard for understanding is that students can explain a concept in their own words, work through its reasoning, and interpret the result. I use their responses to judge when to revisit a foundation and when to move to an application. This approach makes students' understanding central to the pace and sequence of my teaching.

Regular practice and accessible support are essential to this process. Following a worked solution and solving a problem independently make different demands on a learner. Students need time to attempt a task, identify a difficulty, and seek help. They also need ways to revisit an explanation at their own pace and discuss ideas with classmates.

My industry experience informs the importance I place on interpretation and communication. At First Bank of Nigeria, I developed models of customer dormancy and transaction-channel choice to support retention and service decisions. At Konga, I led a data science and engineering team and translated customer-segmentation findings into recommendations for management. These roles required making analysis useful to others. I bring that expectation to teaching by emphasizing clear explanations and documentation that another person can follow.

My research on productivity and technological change in Nigerian banking, published in *Economic Modelling* (2026), offers an application for connecting theory, estimation, and interpretation. Its public replication code provides material for future reproducibility exercises.

Evidence

In Introduction to Econometrics, students struggled to derive ordinary least squares (OLS) estimators and prove their unbiasedness and consistency. I returned to the foundations, deriving the estimators through least squares and the method of moments. I then worked through the proofs, explaining the assumptions each required. I asked students to explain the reasoning back to me and followed this with in-class exercises in which they derived the estimators themselves. Their explanations and derivations gave me evidence that they understood the steps we had discussed.

Once they demonstrated that understanding, I moved to real-life policy applications and hypothesis testing. I also organized extra classes and additional office hours to provide more time to work through difficult concepts.

I encourage students to ask questions and share their reasoning even when they are unsure of an answer. I explain that incorrect answers are a natural part of working toward a correct solution. An incorrect answer is useful because it reveals the reasoning behind it and gives the class something to diagnose. We can identify the mistaken step, revisit the relevant concept, and work toward the correct answer. I respond respectfully to mistakes while making the correction clear. I also call on students at random to explain their reasoning, emphasizing that revision is part of learning.

Student feedback has helped me understand the value of asking students to explain their reasoning. One student wrote, “I know some students don’t like being called on at times (even myself), but I do think it is extremely helpful since most students are confused and just don’t speak up. So with the random calling it does help us go over things that we need help with and are too nervous to talk about.”

I assigned weekly homework and provided additional practice questions so students could work on the material throughout the course. To support this independent work, I created online lecture videos on course topics and difficult concepts and uploaded my slides and lecture notes. Students could pause a recording at a difficult step and revisit the explanation alongside their notes. These resources provided a way to return to an idea when questions arose after class.

I also created an online collaboration platform where students could discuss difficult concepts with classmates before bringing unresolved questions to me. This gave them a setting to articulate a question and consider another student’s approach. Flexible office hours and encouragement to reach out complemented that space with individual support.

In microeconomics, I ask students to predict the effects of a tax, work through the graph, and explain the result in words. The task connects an economic argument to its graphical representation. In R instruction, I work through practical examples linking data preparation, estimation, and interpretation. I explain the econometric ideas alongside their application in the lab, and students work with reproducible scripts. This connects the course concepts to the steps of an analysis and supports the habits of documentation and communication that I value in professional work.

A student in ECON 466 (Introductory Econometrics) described the value of this support: “The course was interesting and even though challenging at times it was manageable with the TA’s help and explanations.”

Conclusion

I aim to equip students with the confidence to engage with economics and the judgment to examine economic problems critically. Across Statistics, Microeconomics, and Econometrics, I combine rigorous reasoning with accessible explanations and practical applications. Solving a technical problem is one part of that learning. Students also need to explain why a method fits the question, when its assumptions are reasonable, and where its conclusions are limited. Through this approach, I work to develop independent thinkers who reason from first principles, communicate their ideas clearly, and approach unfamiliar economic and policy questions with confidence and sound judgment.